

The Practical Guide for Nepali Students | 2025 Edition

Updated with August 2025 Visa Rule Changes · NPR & KRW Salary Guide · All Platforms

■■ Legal Rules — What You MUST Know Before Applying

■ **UPDATED August 2025 — Work Hour Limits Increased!**

Undergraduates: 25 hrs/week (weekdays) + unlimited on weekends & holidays | Postgraduates: 35 hrs/week (weekdays) + unlimited on weekends & holidays | During vacation (summer/winter): Unlimited for all students.

Visa Required	D-2 (Student) or D-4 (Language Training). You CANNOT work without a work permit, even with these visas.
Work Permission	Apply via HiKorea.go.kr before starting any job. Submit your enrollment certificate and employer details. Your university's international office can help.
Minimum Wage 2025	■10,030 per hour (~NPR 1,003/hr). All employers must pay at least this. Overtime (>8 hrs/day) must be paid at 1.5x rate.
What You Can Earn	Working 25 hrs/week at minimum wage = ~■1,000,000–■1,250,000/month (~NPR 100,000–125,000/month).
Forbidden Jobs	Adult entertainment, gambling, hazardous industries, hostess bars. Violating this = visa cancellation + deportation.
Tax & Insurance	Tax is deducted from your paycheck. You can claim a partial tax refund at year-end. Keep all payslips.

■ **CRITICAL WARNING**

Working MORE than your permitted hours is an immigration violation. Even if your employer asks you to, refuse. Violations can result in deportation, visa denial, and being banned from re-entering Korea. Your university can also penalize you.

■ Types of Jobs Available — With Realistic Pay

Job Type	Where to Find	Pay (KRW/hr)	NPR/hr	Korean Needed?	Nepali Suitability
Café / Coffee Shop	Albamon, Karrot, Walk-in	■10,030–■12,000 0	~NPR 1,000–1,200	Basic (TOPIK 1–2)	■■■■ Very Popular

Convenience Store (GS25, CU, 7-Eleven)	Albamon, AlbaCheon, Walk-in	■10,030–■11,000 0	~NPR 1,000–1,100	Basic	■■■■ Easy Entry
Restaurant / Kitchen	Albamon, AlbaCheon	■10,030–■13,000 0	~NPR 1,000–1,300	Basic	■■■■ High Availability
English Tutoring / Hagwon Assist	University boards, Word of mouth	■15,000–■25,000 0	~NPR 1,500–2,500	English fluency needed	■■■■■ Highest Pay!
University Campus Jobs (Library, Admin, Lab)	University career portal, Notice boards	■10,030–■13,000 0	~NPR 1,000–1,300	Low–Medium	■■■■■ Safest Option
Delivery Support / Logistics	Albamon, Karrot	■11,000–■15,000 0	~NPR 1,100–1,500	Minimal	■■■ Good during vacation
Warehouse / Factory (Vacation Only)	Saramin, Job agencies	■12,000–■18,000 0	~NPR 1,200–1,800	Minimal	■■■ Vacation only, physically demanding
Retail / Store Clerk	Albamon, Albain	■10,030–■12,000 0	~NPR 1,000–1,200	Basic–Medium	■■■ Flexible hours
Interpreting / Translation (Nepali-Korean)	SONSIK network, University	■20,000–■40,000 0	~NPR 2,000–4,000	TOPIK 4+ needed	■■■■■ Rare but very high pay

■ #1 Nepali Student Strategy

Start with your university campus job or a nearby café — safe, flexible, and no Korean language requirement beyond basics. Once you have TOPIK Level 2+, apply for tutoring or bilingual retail jobs for significantly higher pay.

■ Where to Find Jobs — All Platforms

A. Korean Job Apps (Download on Android / iOS)

These apps are in Korean — use **Papago** (translation app) to navigate. Search for '외국인 환영' which means 'foreigners welcome' to filter suitable listings.

App	Best For	Key Search Tip	Website
Albamon (알바몬)	Cafés, restaurants, retail — largest volume	Filter '외국인 환영'; sort by distance from your campus	albamon.com
AlbaCheon (알바천도)	Convenience stores, service — huge listings	Use Papago to translate job descriptions before applying	alba.co.kr
AlbaIn (알바인)	Student-friendly jobs — similar to Albamon	Good for finding late-night or early-morning shifts	albain.co.kr
Karrot / Danggeun (당근)	Local gigs near your neighbourhood	Search '파트타임' (part-time) in your exact area for hyper-local jobs	daangn.com
Albachingu (알바친구)	Quick hires, community-driven	Good for one-time or irregular shifts	albachingu.com
Saramin (사라민)	Internships, bilingual & office jobs	Filter for 'English' or bilingual roles if Korean is limited	saramin.co.kr
JobKorea (잡코리아)	Office part-time, bilingual positions	Best for students with intermediate Korean (TOPIK 3+)	jobkorea.co.kr

B. University & Government Resources

- **University Career Service Portal** — Every Korean university has one. Log in with your student ID. Safest source for campus jobs (library, admin, lab assistant, cafeteria).
- **HiKorea.go.kr** — Official immigration site. Apply for work permission here BEFORE starting any job. Required by law.
- **University International Office Notice Boards** — Physical boards outside the international office often have handwritten job offers from local businesses seeking students.
- **Government Employment Support Centers (고용지원센터)** — Free job counselling available in Korean cities. Some have multilingual support.

C. Nepali Community Networks — Often the Fastest Route

- **SONSIK (Society of Nepalese Students in Korea)** — Facebook page with ~12,000 members. Post your job search here — seniors often share leads when they leave a job.
- **Nepalese Community in Busan (NCB)** — Active Facebook group for Busan-based job leads.
- **Your university's Nepali KakaoTalk group** — Join immediately on arrival. Seniors frequently share job openings and employer contacts.

- **Nepali temples and cultural centers** — Word-of-mouth jobs, especially during Nepali festival season (Dashain/Tihar). Korean businesses near temples often seek Nepali speakers.
- **Facebook groups:** 'Nepali in Korea', 'Foreign Students in Korea', city-specific groups — post your availability, skills, and location.

■ Step-by-Step: How to Get Your First Job

Step 1 — Get Work Permission First	Go to HiKorea.go.kr and apply for a work permit (외국인근로자허가증). Submit your student enrollment certificate and your employer's business details. Your university international office will guide you. Do NOT start working before this is approved.
Step 2 — Prepare Your Korean Resume (이력서)	Download a standard Korean 이력서 template (Google '이력서 템플릿'). Include: name, photo, phone, university, visa type, available hours, and any skills. Keep it to 1 page. Many apps let you upload directly.
Step 3 — Download 3 Apps	Install Albamon, AlbaCheon, and Karrot. Set your location to your university neighbourhood. Filter for '외국인' (foreigner). Browse daily — good listings go fast.
Step 4 — Walk Into Nearby Cafés	The most effective method. Walk into GS25, CU, 7-Eleven, or cafés near your campus. Ask 사장님 (sarajangnim)? (Are you hiring part-time?). Many hire on the spot for immediate needs.
Step 5 — Tell Your Seniors	Message your seniors in the Nepali KakaoTalk group and SONSIK. Say: your university, your available hours, and what kind of work you want. Many positions are filled this way before being posted publicly.
Step 6 — Prepare for a Simple Interview	Practice basic phrases: 저는 [이름]입니다 (I am [name]). [시간] [시간] 일 가능합니다 (I can work [N] hours per week). Always bow when greeting. Be on time — punctuality is critical in Korean workplace culture.

■ Monthly Earning Potential — KRW & NPR

Scenario	Hours/Week	Job Type	Monthly KRW	Monthly NPR	Covers?
Minimum (Safe)	10 hrs	Café / Campus	~₩400,000	~NPR 40,000	Transport + Food
Standard (Recommended)	20–25 hrs	Café / Convenience store	~₩800K–₩1M	~NPR 80K–100K	Rent + Food + Transport
High-Earning (Bilingual)	20–25 hrs	English tutoring / Translating	~₩1.2M–₩1.8M	~NPR 120K–180K	Full expenses + savings
Vacation Full Push	40–50 hrs	Factory / Delivery	~₩1.8M–₩2.5M	~NPR 180K–250K	Cover next semester costs

Note: 1 KRW ≈ 0.10–0.11 NPR. Minimum wage 2025 = ■10,030/hour. Verify current exchange rates before financial planning.

■ Insider Tips for Nepali Students

Learn Korean Early	Even TOPIK Level 1–2 doubles your job options. Use apps like Duolingo, Pimsleur, or TTMIK (Talk To Me In Korean — free on YouTube). Universities offer free Korean classes.
Use Papago, Not Google Translate	Papago is built specifically for Korean and is far more accurate for job listings and workplace communication.
Negotiate Shift Timing	Request morning shifts (6AM–9AM) or late evening shifts (9PM–midnight) — these are hardest to fill and employers are more willing to hire foreigners for unsociable hours.
Keep Your Record Clean	One immigration violation can end your study in Korea. Never exceed your work hours. Keep digital and paper copies of your work permit approval.
Tax Refund	At the end of the year, file for a tax refund (■■■■■). International students often overpay and can claim back ■100,000–■300,000. Ask your university's international office for help.
Social Insurance	If you work regularly, your employer should enroll you in National Health Insurance (■■■■■■■) and National Pension (■■■■■). Check your payslip — if deductions appear, you are enrolled.

■ Quick Reference Card

Item	Details
Work Permission	HiKorea.go.kr — apply BEFORE starting work
Undergrad Hours (2025)	25 hrs/week weekdays + unlimited weekends/holidays
Postgrad Hours (2025)	35 hrs/week weekdays + unlimited weekends/holidays
Vacation Hours	Unlimited (summer & winter break)
Minimum Wage 2025	■10,030/hour (~NPR 1,000/hour)
Best Apps	Albamon · AlbaCheon · Karrot · Albain
Best Campus Resource	University international office job board
Nepali Network	SONSIK Facebook · NCB Busan · University KakaoTalk group
Forbidden Jobs	Adult entertainment · Gambling · Hazardous industries
Korean Phrase for Job Hunting	■■ ■■■■■? (Are you hiring part-time?)

Emergency / Questions	HiKorea Immigration Hotline: 1345 (free, some English)
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This guide reflects rules as of August 2025. Immigration rules change — always confirm current work hour limits at [HiKorea.go.kr](https://www.hikorea.go.kr) or with your university international office before applying for any job.

■■■■■■■■■■! Good luck with your studies and work in South Korea! ■■■■